

SHOTGUNS (REPEATING AND SELF-LOADING)

Repeating shotguns, usually equipped with tubular magazines carrying 3–11 cartridges, can fire several rounds in quick succession. The repeating action is commonly a slide, or a pump—a slide bar attached to the forestock which moves the breechblock back and forth. Some shotguns are self-loading, driving their autoloading cycle by gas or recoil operation. Repeating and self-loading shotguns have several applications. For sporting purposes, they allow a hunter to fire several rounds in quick succession at rising birds. This feature also makes them ideal for military or police use, when multiple attackers might be met at close quarters.



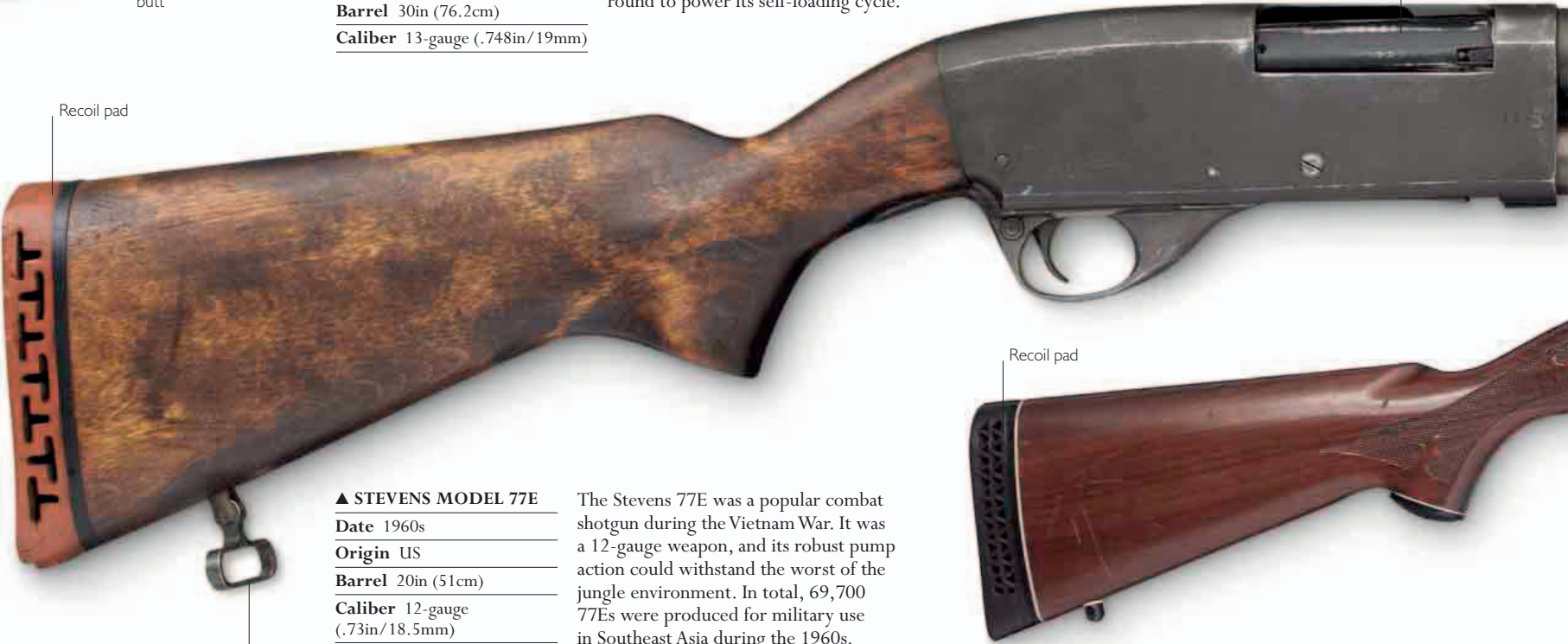
▲ **REMINGTON WINGMASTER PUMP-ACTION SHOTGUN**
Date 1951
Origin US
Barrel 20in (51cm)
Caliber 13-gauge (.748in/19mm)

Fitted with a folding stock and rear pistol grip, this shotgun epitomizes the American police shotgun. Compact and easily stored, it can be quickly brought into service if needed. Its extended magazine also allows it to be loaded with about 4–5 more cartridges than similar sporting versions.



▲ **WINCHESTER MODEL 50**
Date 1954
Origin US
Barrel 30in (76.2cm)
Caliber 13-gauge (.748in/19mm)

Designed jointly by J. L. Lochhead and David M. Williams, the Winchester Model 50 was a recoil-operated weapon. The gun harnessed the recoil energy of the fired round to power its self-loading cycle.



▲ **STEVENS MODEL 77E**
Date 1960s
Origin US
Barrel 20in (51cm)
Caliber 12-gauge (.73in/18.5mm)

The Stevens 77E was a popular combat shotgun during the Vietnam War. It was a 12-gauge weapon, and its robust pump action could withstand the worst of the jungle environment. In total, 69,700 77Es were produced for military use in Southeast Asia during the 1960s.



▲ **FRANCHI SPAS 12**
Date 1978
Origin Italy
Barrel 21½in (54.5cm)
Caliber 12-gauge (.73in/18.5mm)

Developed as a close-combat weapon for both police and military, the Special Purpose Automatic Shotgun (SPAS) is a gas-operated, semiautomatic (with an optional pump mode) and holds eight rounds in an under-barrel tubular magazine. Military or police guns frequently had folding stocks, which allowed the guns to be stored in confined spaces, such as armored vehicles or squad cars.